in each top-level bucket is fed into the next-level bucket for further aggregation. Nested aggregations can be further categorized using more buckets or single-value metrics (`sum`, `avg`, etc.). We look at nested aggregations with examples in the coming sections.

13.1.4 Ignoring results

Search (or aggregation) queries tend to return source documents in the response if not asked to suppress them in the query. We looked at how to manipulate responses in chapter 8, where we configured the `_source`, `_source_includes`, and `_source_excludes` parameters with appropriate settings.

When working with aggregations, the documents in the response are usually unimportant because we're more interested in the aggregations than the source. Under normal circumstances, unfortunately, the source documents are tagged along with the aggregations even when we run the `aggregation` query. If this is not our intention (and usually it is not, when running aggregations), we can tweak the query by setting the `size` parameter to zero. The following snippet shows this approach:

```
GET tv_sales/_search
{
  size = 0                    <-- Sets the size parameter to zero
  "aggs": {
        <<your query goes here>>
      }
    }
  }
}
```

We use this handy parameter (`size=0`) throughout this chapter to suppress source documents as we execute aggregation queries.

As pointed out earlier, aggregations are broadly classified as metric, bucket, or pipeline. In the next section, we look at metric aggregations with sample data specifically tailored for metric calculations. Subsequent sections discuss the remaining aggregations.

13.2 Metric aggregations

Metric aggregations are the simple aggregations we use often in daily life. For example,

- What are the average height and weight of the students in a class?
- What is the minimum hedge trade?
- What are the gross earnings of a best-selling book?

Elasticsearch provides metric functions to calculate most single- and multi-value metrics. If you are wondering what we mean by single- versus multi-value aggregations, this is a simple concept based on the number of outputs.

A single-value metric aggregation is an aggregation on a set of data that outputs a single value, such as `min`, `max`, or `average`. These aggregations work on input documents to produce single-value output data. On the other hand, the `stats` and